



The Six Leadership Styles

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Leadership vs Management

The main difference between leaders and managers is that leaders have people follow them while managers have people who work for them.

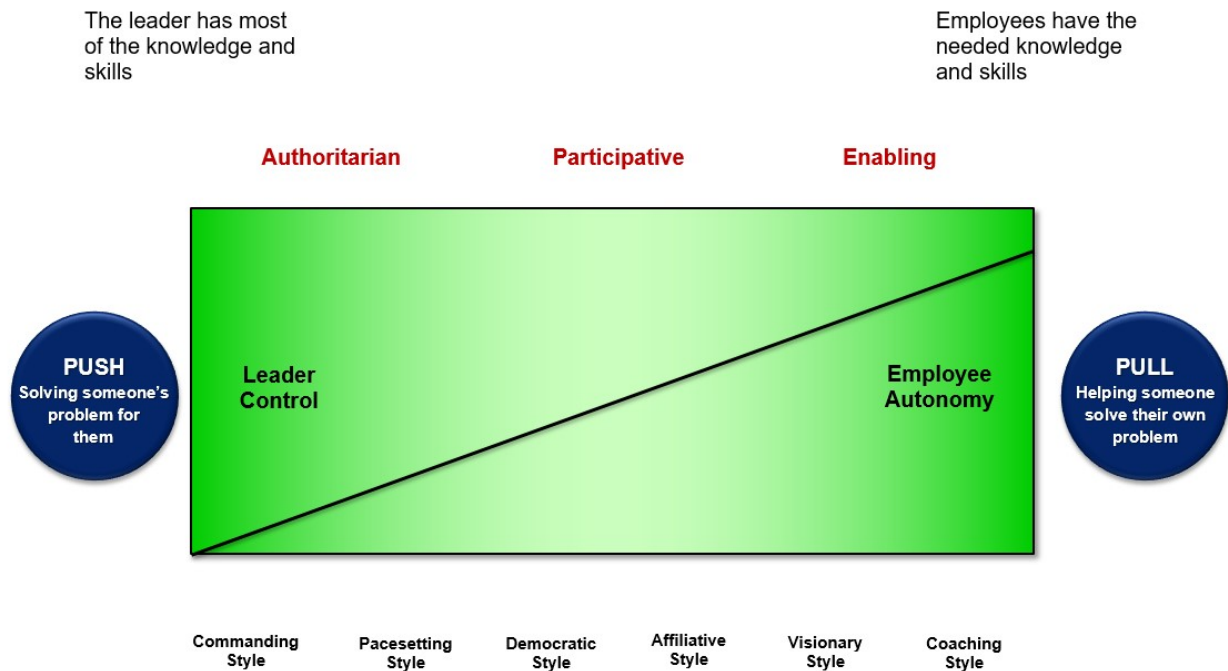
Leadership is about getting people to understand and believe in the vision and to work to achieve goals while managing is more about administering and making sure the day-to-day things are happening as they should.

Leadership	Management
Innovates	Administers
An original	A copy
Inspires trust	Relies on control
Long term view	Short term view
Asks " <i>what</i> " and " <i>why</i> "	Asks " <i>how</i> " and " <i>when</i> "
Tells us where we are going	Gets us there safely, on time, and on budget
Designs	Executes

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Modes of Leadership

Your leadership mode is the manner and approach with which you provide direction, implement plans, and motivate people.



Authoritarian Mode

This mode is used when the leader tells their employees what they want done and how they want it done, without getting the advice of their followers. This mode is appropriate when you have all the information to solve the problem, you are short on time, and your employees are well motivated. Some people tend to think of this mode as a vehicle for shouting, using demeaning language, leading by threats and abusing power. This is not the authoritarian mode...rather it is an abusive, unprofessional mode (called bossing people around). It has no place in a leader's repertoire.

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In normal circumstances the authoritarian mode should only be used on rare occasions. If you have the time and want to gain more commitment and motivation from your employees, then you should use the participative mode.

Participative Mode

The participative mode involves the leader including one or more employees within the decision making process (determining what to do and how to do it). However, the leader maintains the final authority in making decisions. Using this style is not a sign of weakness; rather it is a sign of strength that employees will respect.

This is best used when you have part of the information, and your employees have other parts. Note that a leader is not expected to know everything - this is why you employ knowledgeable and skillful employees. Using this style is of mutual benefit. It allows employees to become part of the decision making process and so allows for better decisions to be made.

Enabling Mode

In this mode, the leader allows the employees to make the decision for themselves or the team. However, the leader is still responsible for the overall decisions that are made. This mode is best used when employees have relevant experience, are able to analyse the situation and determine what needs to be done and how to do it. As a leader, you cannot do everything! You must set priorities and delegate certain tasks.

This is not a mode to use so that you can blame others when things go wrong, rather this is a mode to be used when you have the full trust and confidence in your employees.

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Commanding Style



Primary Objective: Immediate compliance

The primary objective of the Commanding style is immediate compliance.

This style relies on commands and uses very little dialogue. Close monitoring is supported by negative, corrective feedback with an implied, if not explicit, threat. Efforts to motivate are focused mainly on the consequences of non-compliance.

What does the Commanding style look like in action?

When using this style a leader:

- gives lots of directives – tells people what to do without asking for their input or listening to their reactions
- controls team members tightly – through close monitoring
- relies on negative, corrective feedback – focuses on what is being done wrong and what must be corrected
- expects immediate compliance – and may resort to harsh or embarrassing strategies to secure it
- motivates by stating the negative consequences of non-compliance

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The Commanding style is most effective

- with team members doing straightforward tasks
- in crisis situations – when team members need clear directions and the leader has critical information
- when non-compliance will have serious consequences – e.g. safety issues
- with problem team members – when all else has failed
- when the leader needs to give team members immediate clarity about tasks or standards

The Commanding style is least effective

- with team members doing complex tasks – the more complex the task, the more ineffective this style becomes – it can provoke rebellion!
- over the long term – team members are not being developed and may passively resist, rebel or leave
- with self-motivated team members who are capable of directing and monitoring their own work
- with talented, knowledgeable team members who are expected to initiate or innovate

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Pacesetting Style



Primary Objective: Accomplishing tasks to high standards of excellence

The primary focus of the Pacesetting style is task accomplishment to high standards of excellence. Leaders utilising the Pacesetting style tend to lead by modelling. They establish themselves as the standard and are apprehensive about delegating. Their concern with the immediate accomplishment of tasks makes them disinclined to collaborate with their peers, except when they need to obtain or exchange resources.

What does the Pacesetting style look like in action?

When using this style a leader:

- leads by example or acting as a role model and expects others to know the rationale behind what is being modelled or the strategy being followed
- has high standards and little sympathy for poor performance
- tends to work individually – rather than as the leader of the team
- is apprehensive about delegating – delegates demanding tasks only to outstanding performers in the team
- gives detailed task instruction when team members experience difficulties
- takes responsibility for tasks away from team members if high performance is not forthcoming

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The Pacesetting style is most effective

- in making the organisation move fast
- with team members who work to a high level of quality and are able to perform independently to the same standards
- when managing individual contributors who are highly motivated, competent, and know their jobs (e.g., scientists in R&D)
- when the leader needs to help out with the work of the team because of resource or time constraints
- with poor performers who are not showing signs of improvement

The Pacesetting style is least effective

- when team members want feedback, access to their leader, direction, co-ordination and development to improve their performance
- when direction for the team is unclear and team members are not convinced
- when the leader cannot do all their own work personally – for example during periods of growth

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Democratic Style



Primary Objective: Building commitment among employees and generating new ideas

The primary objective of the Democratic style is to build commitment through consensus. This style relies on the ability of team members to establish their own direction and to resolve their conflicts constructively. It is typically characterised by a lot of meetings, a lot of listening, recognition of adequate performance, and little criticism of low performance.

What does the Democratic style look like in action?

When using this style a leader:

- invites team members to make decisions affecting their work
- listens carefully to team members' ideas
- trusts that team members have the capability to develop the appropriate direction for themselves and the organisation
- reaches decisions by consensus
- rewards team performance, rather than addressing individuals with specific feedback

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The Democratic style is most effective

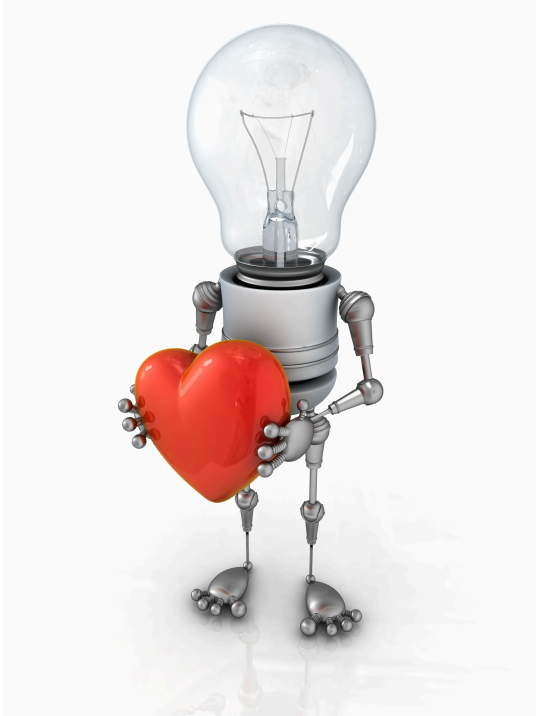
- when team members are competent and they have at least as much information and knowledge as the leader
- when team members' work must be coordinated together
- in instances when a leader is unclear about the best approach or direction and has competent team members who might have clearer ideas

The Democratic style is least effective

- in crises – when there is no time for meetings or discussions
- when team members are incompetent, lack crucial information, or need close supervision

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Affiliative Style



Primary Objective: Creating harmony among employees and between the leader and employees

The primary objective of the Affiliative style is to create harmony and avoid conflict. A leader utilising the Affiliative style spends a lot of time cultivating relationships with employees. This style tends to reward personal characteristics and avoid performance-related confrontations.

What does the Affiliative style look like in action?

When using this style a leader:

- promotes friendly interactions among co-workers
- places less emphasis on task directions, goals and standards than on meeting team members' emotional needs
- pays attention and cares for a person holistically and stresses things that keep people happy
- identifies opportunities for positive feedback and avoids performance related confrontations
- rewards personal characteristics as much as job performance

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The Affiliative style is most effective

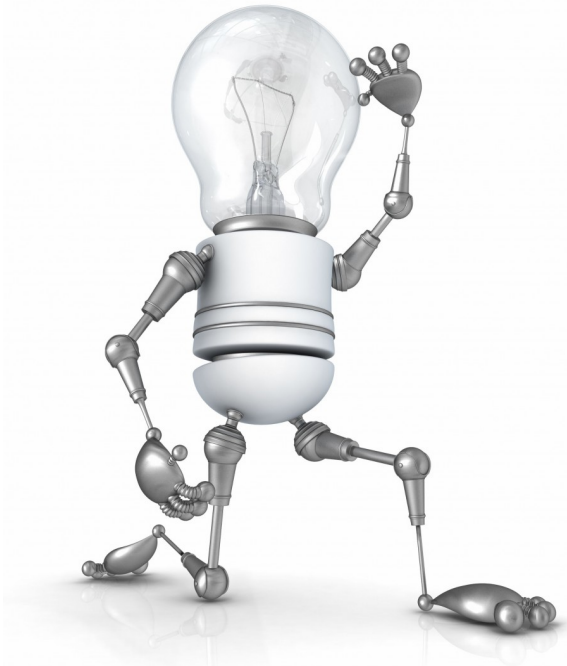
- when tasks are routine and team members' performance is adequate
- when giving personal help (e.g. counselling, supporting individuals through personal difficulties)
- in getting diverse, conflicting groups of individuals to work together harmoniously
- when used as part of a repertoire of all the leadership styles

The Affiliative style is least effective

- when team members' performance is inadequate and corrective performance feedback is necessary for improvement
- in crisis situations or in complex tasks needing clear direction and control
- with team members who are task-orientated or uninterested in friendship with their leader or colleagues

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Visionary Style



Primary Objective: Providing long-term direction and vision for employees

The Visionary style provides long-term direction and vision. This style relies on dialogue with others as well as the leader's unique perspective on the business to establish a vision. The leader keeps others engaged by assuring them that the direction is in the best interests of the group and the organisation for the long term, and by monitoring performance toward the established goals with balanced feedback.

What does the Visionary style look like in action?

When using this style a leader:

- develops and articulates a clear vision and direction for the team
- solicits team members' perspectives on the vision, and the best way to get there, without surrendering authority
- sees selling the vision as a key part of the job
- persuades team members by explaining the reasoning behind the vision
- sets standards and monitors performance in relation to the larger vision
- uses balanced feedback to enhance motivation

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The Visionary style is most effective

- when a new vision or clear direction is needed – in times of change
- with new team members who depends upon the leader for guidance
- when the leader is perceived to be the expert or source of authority

The Visionary style is least effective

- when the leader is not perceived as credible
- when the leader does not develop employees
- with sophisticated and experienced team members who know as much – if not more – than the leader
- when trying to promote self-managed work teams and participative decision-making

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Coaching Style



Primary Objective: Long-term professional development of employees

The primary objective of the Coaching style is the long-term development of others. A leader using the Coaching style helps individuals identify their unique strengths and weaknesses. This typically involves sitting down with the employee and conducting a candid, mutual assessment of the employee's strengths and weaknesses in light of his or her aspirations. The leader helps the employee establish a development plan, providing ongoing support and feedback.

What does the Coaching style look like in action?

When using this style a leader:

- helps team members identify their unique strengths and weaknesses – in the light of their aspirations
- encourages team members to identify long term development goals
- provides on-going feedback to team members about their performance and development efforts
- listens and uses open questions to encourage team members to solve their own work problems
- may trade off immediate standards of performance for long term development – sees mistakes as learning opportunities

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The Coaching style is most effective

- when team members have a clear sense of their aspirations and are motivated to take the initiative
- with team members who are interested in career development and long term planning to achieve their goals
- when team members are required to be innovative, to take calculated risks, to show initiative and to find their own solutions to work problems
- when employees acknowledge a discrepancy between their current level of performance and where they ideally would like to be

The Coaching style is least effective

- when team members need explicit direction and feedback
- with new team members who lack experience in solving their work problems or determining how their day-to-day activities feed into their long term goals
- when the leader lacks knowledge about team members' areas of work
- in crisis situations

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